

China Visa-Free Entry — Pre-Trip Checklist

*A practical pre-trip checklist for international travelers planning a visa-free transit entry to China.
Research-based, 2.0 Editorial Voice.*

1. Confirm Your Eligibility

- **Check whether your nationality is on the current visa-free transit list..** Check whether your nationality is on the current visa-free transit list.
- **Confirm your entry/exit itinerary qualifies (e.g. transit between eligible countries).**
- **Verify the time window (e.g. 144-hour transit) applies to your routing.**
- **Keep your return / onward ticket details ready — many checks ask to see them..** Keep your return / onward ticket details ready — many checks ask to see them.

2. Documents to Carry

- **Valid passport (6+ months validity recommended, with blank pages)..** Valid passport (6+ months validity recommended, with blank pages).
- **Onward / return flight confirmation (print or offline copy)..** Onward / return flight confirmation (print or offline copy).
- **Hotel or accommodation booking confirmation for the transit stay..** Hotel or accommodation booking confirmation for the transit stay.
- **A copy of your visa-free transit policy reference in case questions arise..** A copy of your visa-free transit policy reference in case questions arise.

3. Before You Fly

- **Fill in any required pre-departure forms and save offline copies..** Fill in any required pre-departure forms and save offline copies.
- **Save emergency + embassy contact details on your phone..** Save emergency + embassy contact details on your phone.
- **Arrange mobile connectivity (eSIM) and a payment method that works in China..** Arrange mobile connectivity (eSIM) and a payment method that works in China.
- **Download offline maps and translation tools..** Download offline maps and translation tools.

4. At the Border

- **Join the correct lane (Transit / Visa-free) — ask if unsure..** Join the correct lane (Transit / Visa-free) — ask if unsure.
- **Present passport + onward ticket together when asked..** Present passport + onward ticket together when asked.
- **Answer questions honestly and keep answers short..** Answer questions honestly and keep answers short.
- **Keep the arrival stamp / registration card until you exit..** Keep the arrival stamp / registration card until you exit.

5. Practical Reminders

- **Rules change — always confirm against the latest official notices before travel..** Rules change — always confirm against the latest official notices before travel.
- **Keep digital and paper backups of every document..** Keep digital and paper backups of every document.

- **If your plans change, re-check whether your visa-free window still applies..** If your plans change, re-check whether your visa-free window still applies.

Editorial note: visa-free transit rules and eligibility are updated by official authorities and can change without notice. Always verify against the latest government / embassy guidance before you travel.